

CV Michaël Aklin

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Positions

- 2023-... **Associate Professor of Economics and Management of Technology**, Chair of Policy & Sustainability (PASU), College of Management, EPFL
- 2023-... Co-Managing Director, Enterprise for Society Center, EPFL-UNIL-IMD
- 2019-2023 Associate Professor of Political Science and (by courtesy) Public Policy (tenured), University of Pittsburgh
- 2015-2019 Assistant Professor of Political Science and (by courtesy) Public Policy (tenure track), University of Pittsburgh
- 2014-2015 Postdoctoral fellow, Browne Center, University of Pennsylvania

Education

- 2009-2014 PhD in Politics, New York University
- 2008-2009 MA in Political Economy, University of Essex
- 2003-2007 Licence in International Relations, Graduate Institute of International Studies

Additional training

- 2024 Advanced Academic Leadership Program for the ETH Domain, IMD

Publications

An up-to-date list of publications can be obtained on my Google Scholar page [\[link\]](#).

Books

- [2] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2018. *Escaping the Energy Poverty Trap: When and How Governments Power the Lives of the Poor*. MIT Press.

Reviews: [Caitlin Robinson](#), [Elizabeth Chatterjee](#).

- [1] Aklin, Michaël and Johannes Urpelainen. 2018. *Renewables: The Politics of a Global Energy Transition*. MIT Press.

Reviews: [Foreign Affairs](#), [Nina Kelsey](#), [Varun Sivaram](#), [Josh Busby](#), [Dustin Mulvaney](#)

Articles

- [42] Sai Sudharshan Ravi, Jonas Schnidrig, Du Wen, Evelina Trutnevyte, Michaël Aklin, and François Marechal. Forthcoming. Workload-flexible data centers reduce renewable curtailment in Europe's net-zero energy system. *Cell Reports Sustainability*

- [41] Aklin, Michaël, Mark Buntaine, and Matto Mildenberger. Forthcoming. Public Opinion and the Political Logic of International Climate Pledges. *Global Environmental Politics*
- [40] Aklin, Michaël, Andreas Kern, and Mario Negre. Forthcoming. Is Inequality a Side Effect of Central Bank Independence? *Journal of Politics* [\[link\]](#)
- [39] González-Rostani, Valentina, Liam Beiser-McGrath, and Michaël Aklin. 2026. Labour Market Risk Shapes Individuals' Environmental Attitudes and Policy Preferences. *Ecological Economics* 246: 108973 [\[link\]](#)
- [38] Chiarotti, Edoardo, Boris Thurm, Paola Paruta, Jean-Philippe Bonardi, and Michaël Aklin. 2026. Steering Towards Circularity: Systemic pathways to a more sustainable use of resources in the EU automotive industry. *Sustainable Production and Consumption* 62: 12-27 [\[link\]](#)
- [37] Chakraborty, Mrinmoy, Sakshi Jain, Sophie Thornton, Michaël Aklin, Amanda Giang, and Naomi Zimmermann. 2025. Impact of residential cooking and heating on temporal changes of black carbon in rural India. *Scientific Reports* 15: 33549 [\[link\]](#)
- [36] Aklin, Michaël. 2025. The Political Logic of Just Transition Policies. *Climate Policy* 25:3, 319-334 [\[link\]](#)
- [35] Pelz, Setu, Alexandra Krumm, Michaël Aklin, Vagisha Nandan, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2024. The spatial and economic footprint of the coal industry in rural Jharkhand, India. *Energy Policy* 186: 113973 [\[link\]](#)
- [34] Lim, Junghyun, Michaël Aklin, and Morgan Frank. 2023. Location is a major barrier for transferring US fossil fuel employment to green jobs. *Nature Communications* 14: 5711 [\[link\]](#)
- See our articles in [The Conversation](#) and [VoxEU](#).
- Featured in [Science Magazine](#), [Forbes](#), [News Wise](#), [Technology Networks](#), [Mother Jones](#)
- [33] Blankenship, Brian, Michaël Aklin, Vagisha Nandan, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2022. Jobs for a Just Transition: Evidence on Coal Job Preferences from India. *Energy Policy* 165: 112910 [\[link\]](#)
- [32] Aklin, Michaël, Julia Gray, and Eric Arias. 2022. Inflation and Mass Preferences Over Currency Policy. *Economics & Politics* 34(1): 5-40 [\[link\]](#)
- [31] Pelz, Setu, Michaël Aklin, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2022. Supply preferences and productive electricity use constraints among micro and small enterprises in Bihar, India. *Energy for Sustainable Development* 67: 151-162 [\[link\]](#)
- [30] Aklin, Michaël. 2021. Do High Electricity Bills Undermine Public Support for Renewables? Evidence from the European Union. *Energy Policy* 156: 112400 [\[link\]](#)
- [29] Aklin, Michaël. 2021. The Off-Grid Catch-22: Effective Institutions as a Prerequisite for the Global Deployment of Distributed Renewable Power. *Energy Research & Social Science* 72: 101830 [\[link\]](#)
- [28] Aklin, Michaël and Johannes Urpelainen. 2021. The Evolving Role of Solar-Based Lighting Solutions in Rural India: Global Lessons for Distributed Renewables. *Energy for Sustainable Development* 163: 113-118 [\[link\]](#)
- [27] Aklin, Michaël, Namrata Chindarkar, Johannes Urpelainen, Abhishek Jain, and Karthik Ganesan. 2021. The Hedonic Treadmill: Electricity Access in India Has Increased, But So Have Expectations. *Energy Policy* 156: 112391 [\[link\]](#)
- [26] Aklin, Michaël, Brian Blankenship, Vagisha Nandan, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2021. The Great Equalizer: Inequality in Tribal Energy Access and Policies to Address It. *Energy Research & Social Science* 79: 102132 [\[link\]](#)
- [25] Pelz, Setu, Michaël Aklin, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2021. Electrification and productive use among micro- and small-enterprises in rural North India. *Energy Policy* 156: 112401 [\[link\]](#)
- [24] Aklin, Michaël, Chao-yo Cheng, Johannes Urpelainen. 2021. Inequality in Policy Implementation: Caste and Electrification in Rural India. *Journal of Public Policy* 41(2): 331-359 [\[link\]](#)

- [23] Aklin, Michaël and Andreas Kern. 2021. The Side Effects of Central Bank Independence. *American Journal of Political Science* 57(3): 643-658 [\[link\]](#)
- [22] Aklin, Michaël and Matto Mildenberger. 2020. Prisoners of the Wrong Dilemma: Why Distributive Conflict, Not Collective Action, Characterizes the Politics of Climate Change. *Global Environmental Politics* 20(4): 4-27 [\[link\]](#)
→ Featured in [L'Actualité](#), [The Atlantic](#), [Bloomberg](#), [New York Magazine](#), [New York Times \(1\)](#), [New York Times \(2\)](#)
- [21] Bayer, Patrick and Michaël Aklin. 2020. The European Union Emissions Trading System reduced CO2 emissions despite low prices. *PNAS* 117(16): 8804-8812 [\[link\]](#)
→ Featured in [Ars Technica](#), [BBC](#), [Brookings](#), [Financial Times](#), [Washington Post](#)
- [20] Rosenberg, Meital, Daniel Armanios, Michaël Aklin, and Paulina Jaramillo. 2020. Evidence of Gender Inequality in Energy Use from a Mixed Methods Study in India. *Nature Sustainability* 3: 110–118 [\[link\]](#)
→ Featured in [Business Standard](#), [The Hindu](#), [Times of India](#)
- [19] Aklin, Michaël and Johannes Urpelainen. 2020. Trials and Tribulations: Lost Energy Access Gains in Rural India. *Energy for Sustainable Development* 55: 190-200 [\[link\]](#)
- [18] Aklin, Michaël and Andreas Kern. 2019. Moral Hazard and Financial Crises: Evidence from American Troop Deployments. *International Studies Quarterly* 63(1): 15-29 [\[link\]](#)
→ Featured on [NPR](#)
- [17] Aklin, Michaël. 2018. How Robust Is the Renewable Energy Industry to Political Shocks? Evidence from the 2016 U.S. Elections. *Business & Politics* 20(4): 523–552 [\[link\]](#)
- [16] Aklin, Michaël, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2018. A Global Analysis of Progress in Household Electrification. *Energy Policy* 122: 421-428 [\[link\]](#)
- [15] Aklin, Michaël, Chao-yo Cheng, Johannes Urpelainen. 2018. Social Acceptance of New Energy Technology in Developing Countries: A Framing Experiment in Rural India. *Energy Policy* 113: 466-477 [\[link\]](#)
- [14] Aklin, Michaël, Chao-yo Cheng, Johannes Urpelainen. 2018. Geography, Community, Household: Adoption of Distributed Solar Power across India. *Energy for Sustainable Development* 42: 54-63 [\[link\]](#)
- [13] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2018. Economics of Household Technology Adoption in Developing Countries: Evidence from Solar Technology Adoption in Rural India. *Energy Economics* 72: 35-46 [\[link\]](#)
- [12] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2017. Does Basic Energy Access Generate Socio-Economic Benefits? A Field Experiment with Off-Grid Solar Power in India. *Science Advances* 3(5): 1-8 [\[link\]](#)
→ Featured in [The Economist](#), [Reuters](#)
- [11] Aklin, Michaël. 2016. Re-Exploring the Trade and Environment Nexus Through the Diffusion of Pollution. *Environmental & Resource Economics* 64(4): 663-682 [\[link\]](#)
- [10] Aklin, Michaël, Chao-yo Cheng, Johannes Urpelainen, Karthik Ganesan, and Abhishek Jain. 2016. Factors Affecting Household Satisfaction with Electricity Supply in Rural India. *Nature Energy* 1(16170): 1-6 [\[link\]](#)
- [9] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2015. The Political Economy of Energy Access: Survey Evidence from India on State Intervention and Public Opinion. *Energy Research & Social Science* 10: 250-258 [\[link\]](#)
- [8] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2015. Quantifying Slum Electrification in India and Explaining Local Variation. *Energy* 80(1): 203-212 [\[link\]](#)
- [7] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2014. Information and Energy

Policy Preferences: A Survey Experiment on Public Opinion about Electricity Pricing Reform in Rural India. *Economics of Governance* 15(4): 305-327 [\[link\]](#)

- [6] Aklin, Michaël and Johannes Urpelainen. 2014. The Global Spread of Environmental Ministries: Domestic-International Interactions. *International Studies Quarterly* 58(4): 764–780 [\[link\]](#)
- [5] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2014. Who Blames Corruption for the Poor Enforcement of Environmental Laws? Survey Evidence From Brazil. *Environmental Economics and Policy Studies* 16(3): 241-262 [\[link\]](#)
- [4] Aklin, Michaël and Johannes Urpelainen. 2014. Perceptions of Scientific Dissent Undermine Public Support for Environmental Policy. *Environmental Science & Policy* 28: 173-177 [\[link\]](#)
- [3] Aklin, Michaël and Johannes Urpelainen. 2013. Political Competition, Path Dependence, and the Strategy of Sustainable Energy Transitions. *American Journal of Political Science* 57(3): 643-658 [\[link\]](#)
- [2] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2013. Understanding Environmental Policy Preferences: New Evidence from Brazil. *Ecological Economics* 94: 28-36 [\[link\]](#)
- [1] Aklin, Michaël and Johannes Urpelainen. 2013. Debating Clean Energy: Frames, Counter Frames, and Audiences. *Global Environmental Change* 23(5): 1225-1232 [\[link\]](#)

Books chapters

- [4] Aklin, Michaël and Patrick Bayer. 2023. The Politics of Sustainability: Energy Efficiency, Carbon Pricing, and the Circular Economy. In Daniel Scholten (ed). *Handbook on the Geopolitics of the Energy Transition*. Edward Elgar. [\[link\]](#)
- [3] Aklin, Michaël. 2022. Renewable Energy, Energy Poverty, and Climate Change: Opportunities and (Many) Challenges. In Jeannie Sowers, Stacy D. VanDeveer, and Erika Weinthal (eds). *Oxford Handbook on Comparative Environmental Politics*. Oxford University Press [\[link\]](#)
- [2] Aklin, Michaël. 2018. International Relations Theories and Climate Change Politics. In Urs Luterbacher and Detlef Sprinz (eds). *Global Climate Policy: Actors, Concepts, and Enduring Challenges*. MIT Press [\[link\]](#)
- [1] Aklin, Michaël, Eric Arias, Emine Deniz, and B. Peter Rosendorff. 2015. Domestic Politics of Trade Policy. In Robert Scott and Stephen Kosslyn (eds). *Emerging Trends in the Social and Behavioral Sciences*. John Wiley and Sons [\[link\]](#)

Reports

- [10] ILO. 2025. Mapping just transition in NDCs 3.0 - global trends: Insights from 123 countries, Geneva: International Labour Office [\[link\]](#)
- [9] Bouallou, Rita, Alejandro Nuñez-Jimenez, and Michaël Aklin. 2025. The TAPIR framework: A new tool to assess climate and energy demonstration projects. Coalition for Green Energy Storage (CGES) [\[link\]](#).
- [8] Gaudard, Ludovic, Louisa Savereide, and Michaël Aklin. 2024. Techno-Economic Evaluation of Clean Cooking Technologies in Displacement Contexts. UNHCR Report.
- [7] Viswamohan, Anjali, Shruti Sharma, Michaël Aklin, and Tom Moerenhout. 2022. Targeting Agricultural Electricity Subsidies in Haryana. IISD/GSI Report [\[link\]](#)
- [6] Bijlani, Diksha, Michaël Aklin, Brian Blankenship, Vagisha Nanda, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2022. Jharkhand Rural Energy Access: Enduring Challenges in Quality, Affordability, and Billing. ISEP and Oak Foundation [\[link\]](#)
- [5] Sharma, Shruti, Tom Moerenhout, Michaël Aklin, and Kavya Bajaj. 2021. How to Target LPG Subsidies in India: Evaluating policy options in Jharkhand. IISD/GSI Report [\[link\]](#)
- [4] Sharma, Shruti, Tom Moerenhout, and Michaël Aklin. 2020. How to Target Residential Electricity Subsidies in India. IISD/GSI Report [\[link\]](#)

- [3] Aklin, Michaël. 2019. Global Progress in Electrification. ISEP Policy Brief 2019-2 [\[link\]](#)
- [2] Aklin, Michaël, Patrick Bayer, S.P. Harish, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2017. Small off-Grid solar systems displace kerosene, but evidence for social and economic impact remain weak. ISEP Policy Brief 2017-1 [\[link\]](#)
- [1] Jain, Abhishek, Sudatta Ray, Karthik Ganesan, Michaël Aklin, Chao-Yo Cheng, and Johannes Urpelainen. 2015. Access to Clean Cooking Energy and Electricity. New Delhi: Council on Energy, Environment and Water [\[link\]](#)

Book reviews

- [2] Aklin, Michaël. 2023. Review of *Twisting in the Wind: The Politics of Tepid Transitions to Renewable Energy*, by Oksan Bayulgen. *Perspective on Politics* 21(2): 763-764. [\[link\]](#)
- [1] Aklin, Michaël. 2022. Review of *Political Economies of Energy Transition: Wind and Solar Power in Brazil and South Africa*, by Kathryn Hochstetler. *Political Science Quarterly* 137(2): 424–426 [\[link\]](#)

Invited speaker and guest lectures (selection)

Academic

Selected list (not including larger conferences):

2026: IE-Rochester CLARE Conference, University of Lausanne HEC. 2025: Geneva Graduate Institute, Universität St.Gallen, NYU Petralia Conference. 2024: Stockholm School of Economics, UC Santa Barbara, University of Bern. 2023: UT Austin, ETHZ, UC Santa Barbara. 2022: Columbia, University of Pennsylvania, Carnegie Mellon. 2021: University of British Columbia, University of Lucerne. 2020: World Bank. 2019: ETHZ, New York University. 2018: ETHZ, University of Pennsylvania, Strathclyde University.

Other audiences

Policy and industry: Inter-American Bank for Development (IDB), RENT, UNCTAD, UNHCR, World Bank.
General public: AGAB, Durabilitas, Sustainability Days, Sustainable Science Forum (SCNAT).

Prizes and academic awards

Inaugural *Leman Fellow*, Hoffmann Center for Global Sustainability, Geneva Graduate Institute (2025-2027)

Excellence in Reviewing Award, *British Journal of Political Science* (2025)

Winner of the Best Teacher award, Management of Technology Section, EPFL (2025)

Winner of the Research Impact on Practice Award, Academy of Management (2021)

Education

Teaching

Undergraduate (BSc and BA)

Climate Change and Public Policy [Pitt]

Global Environmental Politics [Penn, Pitt]

Politics of COVID (course coordinator) [Pitt]

Politics and Financial Crises [Pitt]

Sustainability (one session) [EPFL]

Graduate (MSc and PhD)

Econometrics [EPFL, Pitt]

Technology, Sustainability, and Public Policy [EPFL]

International Political Economy of Developing Countries [Pitt]

Political Economy of Growth [Pitt]

Executive education/EMBA

Innovation and Public Policy [EPFL]

Sustainable Innovation [EPFL]

Sustainability Challenges of Renewable Energy [EPFL]

Master's projects

<i>Date</i>	<i>Name</i>	<i>Host of the master's project</i>
Ongoing	Philipp Hatzold	Persistent
	Hamza Akeddar	Ville de Lausanne
	Oscar Prangé	EDF Power Solutions
2026	Jeanne Allocio	Occitane
2025	Igor Dallemagne	EPFL (academic thesis)
	Sven Mahon	Zephyr
	Shara Vigneswaran	Romande Energie
	Shiqi Yang	Solar Impulse
2024	March Chavanne	Leclanché
	Jingqi Liu	Hilti
	Noé Lopez	Persistent
	Francesco Tripoli	EPFL/MIT (academic thesis)

Former PhD students

<i>Date</i>	<i>Name</i>	<i>Placement</i>
2018-2024	Qing Chang (Chair)	Postdoc, School of Computation, University of Pittsburgh
2018-2024	Valentina Gonzalez	Postdoc, Princeton
		→ Assistant Professor (tenure-track), University of Southern California
2016-2022	Maxfield Peterson	Postdoc, Australian National University
		→ Washington State Department of Ecology
2016-2021	Junghyun Lim	Postdoc, Princeton
		→ Postdoc, University of Pennsylvania
		→ Assistant Professor (tenure track), UNC Chapel Hill
2015-2021	Ignacio Mamone	Nielsen
		→ Accenture
2015-2021	Josh Counselman	ACA Group

External examiner for PhD candidates at ETH Zurich (2023), NTNU (2022), and Aalto (2022).

Funding record

External funding since 2010 (as PI, co-PI, or team member) (total: about \$2m): *Swiss National Science Foundation, UBS, Carnegie Corporation of New York, Heinz Endowments, International Growth Centre (2x), Oak Foundation, Shakti Foundation, ClimateWorks, Browne Center, British Academy.*

Media

La robustesse géo-économique plutôt que la réindustrialisation (with Mathias Thoenig), *Le Temps*, March 27, 2025 [\[link\]](#)

Le casse-tête de la loi sur l'électricité, *Le Temps*, May 29, 2024 [\[link\]](#)

Green jobs for fossil fuel workers: The implications of geography and skills for the clean energy transition, *VoxEU*, December 23, 2023 [\[link\]](#)

Enable a just transition for American fossil fuel workers through federal action, *Brookings*, August 2, 2022 [\[link\]](#)

Le mieux est l'ennemi du bien : les bienfaits de la loi sur le CO2 compensent ses carences, *Le Temps*, October 20, 2020 [\[link\]](#)

Middle-Income Countries Big Winner from Off-Grid Energy. Who's Next? *Power for All*, November 22, 2018 [\[link\]](#)

Six Nuclear Reactors Worth of Off-Grid Renewable Energy Deployed in Last 10 Years – But Sub-Saharan Africa Lagging, *Power for All*, November 20, 2018 [\[link\]](#)

How India's impressive electrification compares with South Asian nations, *The Print*, September 13, 2018 [\[link\]](#)

Off-grid power not a silver bullet for rural India, *Swissinfo*, August 16, 2017 [\[link\]](#)

Off-grid solar power and the future of rural electrification in India, *Ideas for India*, July 17, 2017 [\[link\]](#)

Can solar micro-grids deliver basic electricity access in Indian villages? *Ideas for India*, April 17, 2015 [\[link\]](#)

La Suisse doit reprendre l'initiative en Europe avec une politique énergétique proactive, *Le Temps*, October 31, 2014 [\[link\]](#)

How (not) to talk about climate change, *Washington Post*, May 22, 2014 [\[link\]](#)

Service

Policy and industry

2025-... Canton of Vaud's *Economic Strategy 2050*, Steering Committee

Academia

- 2018-... Environmental Politics & Governance (EPG), member of the International Steering Committee
- 2025 Environmental Politics & Governance (EPG), co-organizer of the annual conference
- 2023 European Political Science Association (EPSA), chair of the *Public Policy & Public Administration* track
- 2022 International Political Economy Society (IPES), co-organizer of the annual conference
- 2018 American Political Science Association, committee member for best book award, International Collaboration section
- 2013-... I peer-reviewed about 280 papers in outlets including (energy) *Science*, *Joule*, *Nature Energy*, *Nature Sustainability*, *Nature Communications*, etc.; (political science/public policy) *American Political Science Review*, *American Journal of Political Science*, *Journal of Politics*, *Journal of Public Policy*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *International Organizations*, etc.; (economics) *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*, *Journal of Environmental Management*, etc.

EPFL

- 2026-... EPFL Energy Center (CEN), advisory board member
- 2025-... EPFL Advisory Board for Impact (chaired by VPI and VPS), board member
- 2024-... Science and Policy Action Network (student association), academic advisor
- 2024-... Academic leadership of the *Integrated Approach to Energy Transition* CAS of the *Sustainable Energy Systems Engineering* program
- 2023-... College of Management, member of the Direction committee
- 2023-... College of Management, member of the Doctoral committee
- 2023-... College of Management, faculty search committee (2x)
- 2023-... Sustainable Economy Forum UBS-E4S, steering committee
- 2025 School of Basic Sciences, faculty search committee (statistics)
- 2023-2025 Coalition for Green Energy and Storage (CGES), lead of the Working Group on technology assessment (jointly with Alejandro Nuñez-Jimenez, ETHZ)
- 2024 AVP-SAO, public engagement officer, search committee member
- 2023-2024 Constellation on energy, sustainability and climate (C-ESC), committee member
- 2023-2024 European Society for Engineering Education (SEFI) conference, International Scientific Committee

University of Pittsburgh

- 2022-2023 Arts & Sciences tenure council
- 2020-2023 Arts & Sciences promotion and tenure committee (ad hoc)
- 2021-2023 Arts & Sciences undergraduate council
- 2020-2023 Department of Political Science, Director of Academic Placement
- 2018-2020 Department of Political Science, Director of Undergraduate Studies
- 2016-2019 Arts & Sciences grant committee

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